

Natalie Austin

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San Diego, CA
Open to Relocating

Profile

Neurobiology graduate with experience spanning laboratory research, fragrance compounding at Le Labo, and creative development. Combines scientific curiosity with an eye for culture, translating observations about consumer preferences and emerging trends into product and experience concepts, including a footwear launch brought from concept to life. Drawn to work that connects science, scent, and design to how people feel, experience, and choose products.

Experience

Trend Research & Creative Strategy Assistant

Jan. 2025 – Present

Future Is Color

San Diego, CA

- Research cultural and fashion trends and develop trend reports to inform merchandise, future events, and potential brand collaborations; contribute to merchandise design and creative direction.
- Conceived the *Eden* footwear name, developed visual direction boards for campaign photography, and assisted with shoots for the produced shoe collaboration.
- Planned the Eden launch party and designed and installed the storefront environment; collaborated with a private chef on the menu and wine pairings for an event featuring DJs and a silent disco.
- Assisted the founder with a proposed streaming-platform collaboration, participating in client meetings and developing visual research, creative direction materials, and preliminary T-shirt designs using Adobe Creative Suite.

Lab Technician / Keyholder (Part-Time)

Jan. 2025 – May 2026

Le Labo, The Estée Lauder Companies

San Diego, CA

- Compounded made-to-order fragrances using exact formulas, tared balances, and precise ingredient measurements; verified labels and completed product-quality checks.
- Balanced compounding and customer-facing responsibilities in a fast-paced luxury fragrance environment while maintaining preparation accuracy and consistent product quality.
- Monitored ingredient and supply inventory, coordinated replenishment, and maintained tools and work areas according to established sanitation and chemical-handling procedures.

Lab Assistant

May 2024 – Dec. 2024

Hibbs Lab

San Diego, CA

- Prepared buffers, reagents, and samples using concentration and dilution calculations, analytical balances, and micropipettes in support of neuronal receptor research.
- Performed PCR, gel electrophoresis, and bacterial culture; supported protein expression and purification while following established protocols and contamination-control procedures.
- Collaborated with researchers to troubleshoot preparation procedures and investigate potential sources of experimental inconsistency.
- Documented experimental results and procedural changes, maintained detailed records, and wrote and revised laboratory protocols.

Education

Bachelor of Science in Neurobiology

2025

University of California, San Diego

San Diego, CA

Relevant Coursework: Organic Chemistry Laboratory; Computational Neurobiology Laboratory

Teaching: Instructional Assistant, BILD 1 — explained biological concepts and guided scientific problem-solving.

Skills & Interests

Creative Research: Cultural and consumer trend analysis, trend reporting, visual research and creative direction, merchandise concept development, product naming, experiential launch planning

Laboratory Methods: PCR, gel electrophoresis, bacterial culture, protein expression and purification, buffer and reagent preparation, micropipetting, analytical balances

Research and Quality: Concentration and dilution calculations, experimental documentation, protocol and SOP development, troubleshooting, contamination control, product-quality checks, chemical safety, autoclave operation

Web, Data, and Software: HTML, CSS, responsive web design, basic JavaScript, Python, LabChart, Adobe Creative Suite, LaTeX, Microsoft Office

Languages: English, Spanish | **Interests:** Film, vintage fashion, cephalopod neurobiology, and fragrance collecting